

Exercise 10: Personal Values

Purpose:

Establish values that govern decisions and allow cadets to reflect on how their values influence their personalities and leadership styles.

Step 1:

Have each person rip a piece of paper into ten pieces.

Step 2:

Ask them to write down the ten things in their life that they value the most, one on each piece of paper, in the form of a value. In other words, rather than the name of a specific person, put down, for example, “friendship,” “family” or “trust”.

Step 3:

When everyone has their ten pieces of paper, ask the participants to spread them out in front of them so that they can see them clearly.

Step 4:

Tell the participants that they now have 30 seconds to pick the three values that are the least important to them and throw them away. Be strict on the deadlines. They are to use their gut feelings and therefore should have a narrow window of time to choose.

Step 5:

Give them 20 seconds to throw away two more pieces of paper.

Step 6:

Give them 20 seconds to throw away two more. They should now have three scraps left with their three most important values.

Step 7:

Lead a group discussion. Do not force cadets to speak but encourage them to share their thoughts with one another. The trainers can modify questions or come up with their own to effectively guide the conversation.

Discussion Questions:

1. What were your three most important values?
2. How do you feel about the values you ended up with? Were they expected?
3. How do these values show themselves in your everyday life?
4. What actions do you take that evidence them?
5. What actions would you like to take to live by them?